

DERM — Deployment Ethics & Release Module

Parent Standard: Ethical Layer Standard
Protocol: EVIP® — Ethical Virtual Integrity Protocol
Category: Governance & Enforcement
Subcategory: Ethical Deployment & Release Conditions
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Compatibility: OOF® Methodology OS™ · **Ethical Layer Standard** · EVIP® · INTEGROS® · TVL® · UCL™
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Canonical Language: English (UCL™)

Canonical Definition

Deployment Ethics & Release Module defines the structural conditions under which a methodology, system, device, hardware structure, AI environment, autonomous process, or future technology may be ethically released, deployed, scaled, or activated.

A system satisfies DERM only if:

- release is bounded by ethical legitimacy
- deployment does not occur before ethical passage is established
- scale does not override unresolved ethical invalidity
- activation conditions are governed before operational exposure begins
- ethical validity is denied where deployment proceeds despite unresolved harm, sustainability, legitimacy, or human
- interaction failures

A system that is released without ethical passage does not satisfy DERM.

Module Function

DERM defines the final ethical gate before operational reality.

It ensures that no methodology, system, or technology may pass ethical layer conditions if it is released, deployed, activated, or scaled before ethical validity has been structurally established.

The module applies wherever a system moves from design, testing, simulation, or internal development into real operational exposure.

Minimum Implementation Framework (MIF)

Step 1 — Define the Deployment Boundary

The organization must define what counts as release, deployment, activation, or scale.

Minimum requirement:

- deployment boundary is explicit
 - activation conditions are identifiable
 - movement into operational reality is not treated as undefined transition
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Step 2 — Define Ethical Readiness Conditions

The organization must define what ethical conditions must be satisfied before deployment.

Minimum requirement:

- ethical readiness criteria are explicit
 - unresolved invalidity is visible
 - ethical passage is not assumed from technical readiness alone
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Step 3 — Define Release Restrictions

The system must define when release is blocked, limited, delayed, or denied.

Minimum requirement:

- restriction conditions are explicit
 - unresolved human harm, sustainability failure, boundary overreach, or invalid interaction conditions block valid release
 - commercial or operational pressure does not erase restriction logic
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Step 4 — Define Escalation and Review Path

The system must define how unresolved ethical invalidity is escalated before deployment proceeds.

Minimum requirement:

- review or escalation path exists
 - deployment is not treated as automatic once capability exists
 - unresolved ethical invalidity **cannot** be silently carried into operation
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Step 5 — Preserve Ethical Priority Over Scale

The system must preserve ethical legitimacy above speed, rollout pressure, efficiency, or market opportunity.

Minimum requirement:

- scale does not override ethical passage
- growth does not validate unresolved invalidity
- operational urgency does not replace ethical legitimacy

Step 6 — Restrict Invalid Operational Entry

The system must not be treated as ethically valid if it enters operational reality without ethical passage.

Minimum requirement:

- invalid release conditions are identifiable
- unresolved ethical failure blocks valid deployment
- functionality alone does not justify activation

Use Case 1 — AI System Release

Scenario

An organization prepares to release an AI system that is technically functional, commercially attractive, and operationally ready, but some ethical **validity conditions** remain unresolved.

Application

DERM is used to ensure:

- the deployment boundary is explicit
- ethical readiness conditions are defined
- unresolved invalidity blocks release
- commercial pressure does not override ethical passage

Result

The organization gains a stronger ethical gate preventing technically ready systems from entering reality before ethical legitimacy has been established.

Use Case 2 — Hardware or Autonomous Technology Deployment

Scenario

A hardware-linked or autonomous technology is ready for activation in a live environment where its real-world effects may become immediate, scalable, and difficult to reverse.

Application

DERM is used to ensure:

- release and activation conditions are governed
 - unresolved ethical risk is visible before deployment
 - escalation and restriction logic exists
 - operational entry is blocked where ethical passage is incomplete
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Result

The organization gains a stronger structural boundary ensuring that real-world deployment is controlled by ethical legitimacy, not only by technical capability or deployment readiness.

Canonical Closing Statement

If deployment begins before ethical passage is established, ethical validity has not been achieved.

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Canonical Source

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